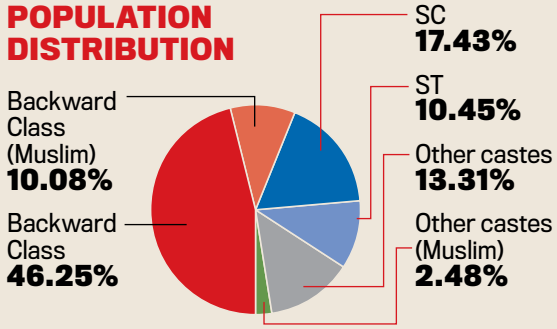
TELANGANA CASTE COUNT FINDINGS

96.9% Households surveyed

35,477,554 Individuals covered

POPULATION DISTRIBUTION



THE OBC NUMBERS

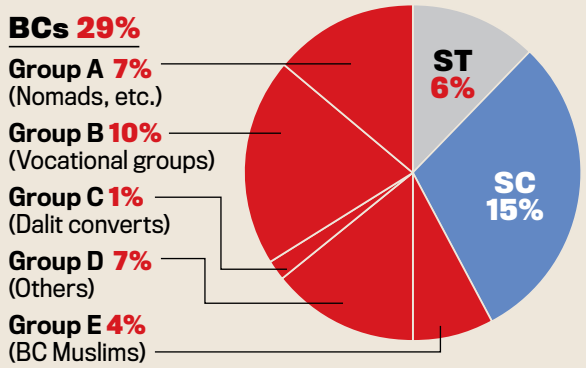
There has been no nationwide caste census since 1931. Bihar did a survey in 2023

Census 1931	Bihar caste survey	Telangana caste survey*
52%	63.1%	56.3%

**including BC Muslims*

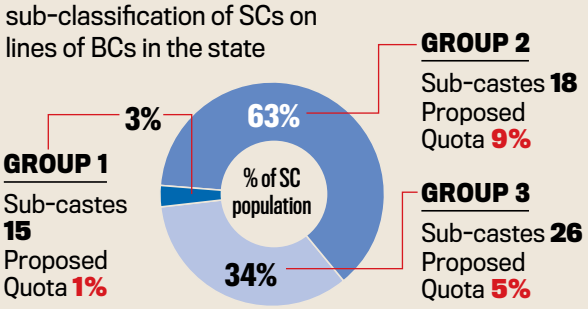
EXISTING RESERVATIONS

What each marginalised group is entitled to in education and jobs in the state's 50% quota



THE SC STRATIFICATION

Justice Shameem Akhtar Commission has recommended sub-classification of SCs on lines of BCs in the state



numbers could be much higher. This was also evidenced by the 2023 Bihar survey, which found OBCs to constitute 63.1 per cent of the state's population.

The Congress regime's reluctance to make the caste survey report public is not without precedent. A similar exercise, the 'Samagra Kutumba Survey', conducted in 2014 under the leadership of then chief minister K. Chandrashekar Rao, was also kept under wraps. Despite Revanth's criticism of KCR for not releasing the report, his own government has now followed a similar path. Nonetheless, he has positioned himself as a champion of social justice, seeking to outmanoeuvre KCR's Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) and the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP). Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, who has ardently backed a nationwide caste census in recent times, is now citing the Telangana survey as a template for such an exercise. Speaking in the Lok Sabha on February 3, the leader of the Opposition argued that such data is essential for the equitable distribution of resources.



"The Telangana govt is committed to lowering the inequalities among various communities by bringing proactive and affirmative policies"

A. REVANTH REDDY, *Chief Minister, Telangana*

While the survey has been hailed as a step towards data-driven governance, the landscape downstream is challenging. The revelation that BCs constitute 56.33 per cent of the population has already led to demands for increased reservations, particularly in local body elections. BC leaders are demanding 42 per cent reservation, up from the current 34 per cent, and have warned of a massive agitation if their demands are not met. (Unlike in education and employment, where BCs are stratified into five groups receiving a combined 29 per cent reservation, they are treated as a single group in local body elections.)

The sub-classification of Dalits adds another layer of complexity. The government has accepted the Justice Shameem Akthar Commission's overall proposal to divide the 59 SC sub-castes into three groups, allocating 15 per cent reservations in a 1+9+5 combination. However, it rejected the commission's recommendation to exclude the creamy layer—Dalits who have attained affluence—from the ambit of quotas.

Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY